

Case Study - Danelle Schlebusch

The problem

Every month, the team captured sourcing data by hand in Excel — five business units, five to ten initiatives updated out of a pool of twenty to thirty. Every month, someone rebuilt the graphs from scratch.

What I did and decided

I built a Power App for data capture, a SQL Server database to hold it, and a Power BI dashboard that reads from the database automatically. Before building the app, I made a wireframe and reviewed it with stakeholders — that caught a missing BU-level target field. I split the data into two tables, so that when someone edited a past month's numbers, the old value stayed on record instead of being overwritten. During the dashboard build, stakeholders explained that initiative values needed to roll over across a twelve-month lifetime that doesn't follow the calendar year, and I built that into the calculations. I first used SQL Server triggers to calculate year-to-date values, but they caused the Power App's data submission to fail with a network error. I removed the triggers, tried again, and the data submitted. So I moved the same calculations into SQL views instead.

What came of it

The team adopted it and did make use of it. Capturing new data takes about five minutes in the Power App, and the new data is then reflected in the dashboard automatically — no more rebuilding graphs by hand.

What I'd do differently

I'd move the year-to-date calculations out of SQL views and into DAX inside the dashboard, to keep a proper star schema.